

DATA ANALYSIS

Applicant Data Analysis

Blackpool and The Fylde College -
Assessment

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Dataset Overview

What was analysed and how

7,240

Total Records

21

Columns

2018-2019

Date Range

2 Sheets

Excel Source

Data Includes

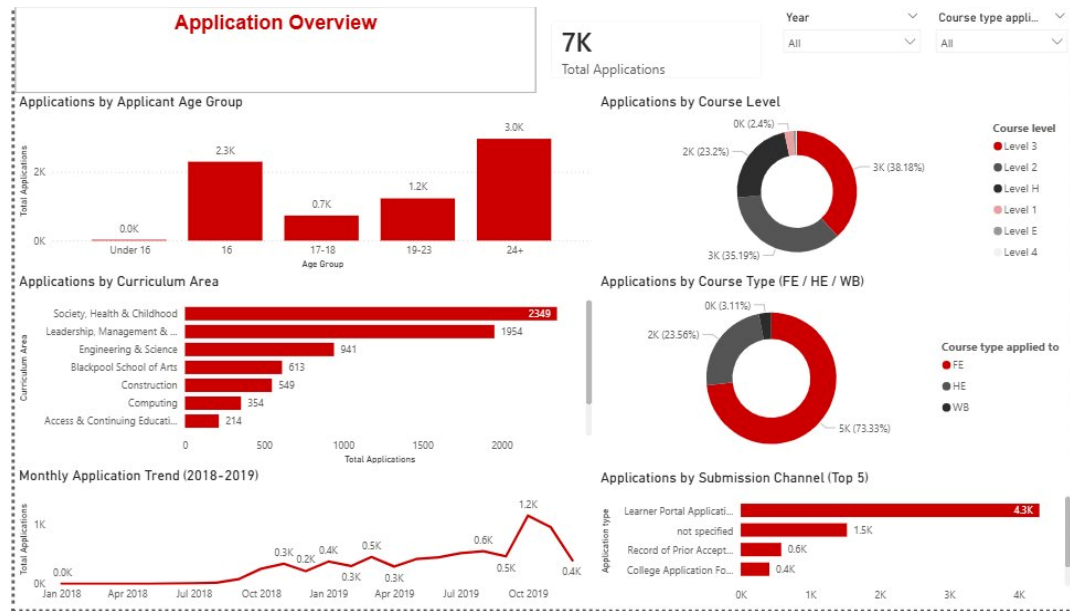
- One row per applicant application
- Covers FE, HE and Work-Based courses
- Linked to Progress Codes reference table
- Age groups: Under 16 through 24+
- 9 curriculum areas represented

Also Covers

- Enrolment outcome recorded (0/1 flag)
- Course match tracking (applied vs enrolled)
- Pass/fail outcome field (sparse - 135 records)
- Geographic fields: town and postcode
- Application channel captured (10 types)

Key Findings - Applications

What the application data tells us



Power BI Dashboard - Page 1

73%

of applications are for FE courses

38%

are Level 3 - the most popular level

41%

of applicants are aged 24+

Oct
2019

peak application month

2,349

apps in Society, Health & Childhood - #1 area

Key Findings - Enrolment

Conversion rates, course matching and outcome patterns

4K

Total Enrolled

49%

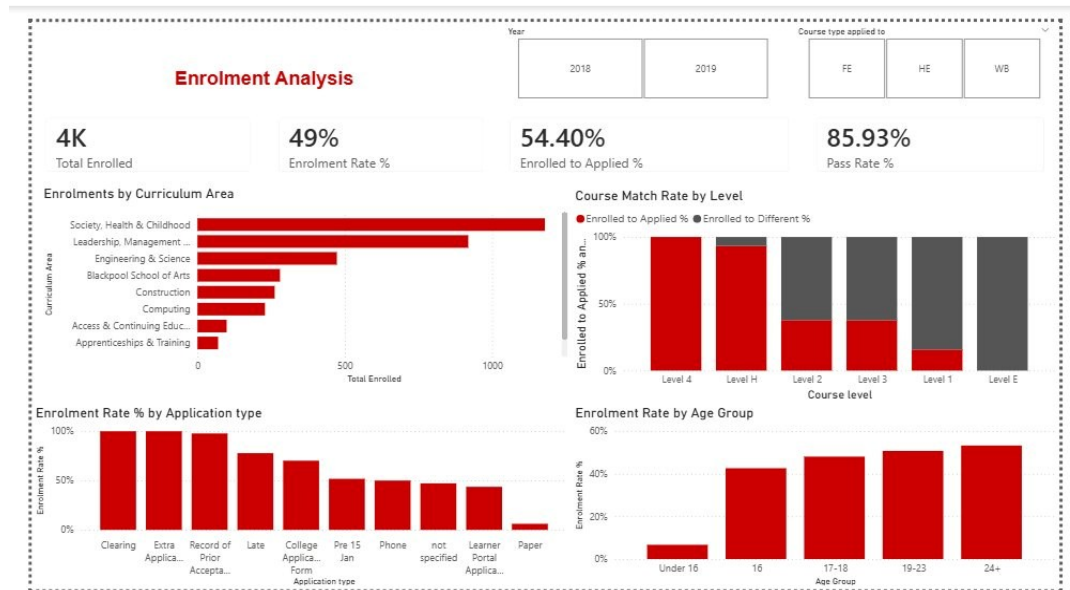
Enrolment Rate

54%

Enrolled to Applied Course

86%*

Pass Rate



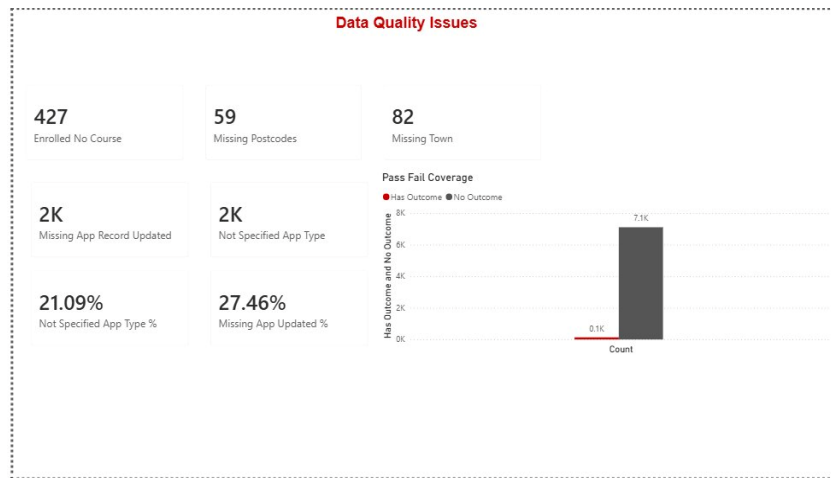
Key Observations

- Clearing & Extra applications have 100% enrolment rate - highly committed applicants
- Learner Portal (largest channel) converts at only 47%
- Level 4 and Level H have highest course-match rates
- 24+ age group has highest enrolment rate at 53%
- Under 16 enrolment rate is only 9% - flag for review

*Based on 135 recorded outcomes only - not statistically representative

Data Quality Issues

8 issues identified across structure, completeness and consistency



Power BI Dashboard - Page 3

High	Medium	Low
Enrolled applicants with no course recorded		427 records
Inflated Excel used range (phantom null rows)		Source file
Missing Application Record Updated	1,988 (27.5%)	
Blank or malformed postcodes	60 records	
Progress codes absent from reference sheet	4 codes	
Not Specified application type	1,527 (21%)	
Missing town	82 records	
Pass/fail data sparse - timing issue likely	135 of 3,537	

Recommendations

Actionable next steps based on the analysis

01

Remediate the 427 enrolment records with no course

Cross-reference these records against the student enrolment system to populate the missing course codes. This affects both reporting accuracy and any downstream funding calculations.

02

Standardise the application type field

21% of records (1,527) have 'not specified' as application type. Introduce a mandatory field in the application system, or backfill using the created-by and date fields where possible.

03

Document undocumented progress codes

Four codes (INFO2, INHSAPP, 1BOOKRET, WPISSUED) appear in the data but not in the reference sheet. These should be formally defined and added to the reference table to enable accurate status reporting.

04

Investigate Under-16 enrolment rate (9%)

Under-16 applicants show a significantly lower conversion rate than all other age groups. Understanding whether this is a deliberate policy or a data/process issue could improve engagement with this cohort.

Improving the Analysis

Additional Data Needed

Student Outcomes

- Grades (distinction / merit / pass) not just pass/fail
- Withdrawal date and reason
- Attendance rate key predictor of completion

Applicant Demographics

- Full clean postcodes for deprivation index mapping
- Prior attainment/entry qualifications
- Ethnicity and disability flags for widening participation

Financial & Funding

- Funding source per student (ESFA, employer, self-funded)
- Fee waiver/bursary flag correlates with retention

Application Process

- Interview outcome and offer date (funnel drop-off)
- Course capacity vs demand per subject area

If This Were Our Organisation

01

Fix at Source

Mandatory Application Type dropdown in CRM. Enforce course selection at enrolment. Add withdrawal reason field. Eliminates the top 3 data gaps immediately.

02

Replace Excel with Live MIS Connection

Connect Power BI directly to the student MIS (ProSolution / Tribal SITS). Removes manual file handling, inflated range issues and enables daily refresh.

03

Build a Retention Early-Warning Dashboard

Flag at-risk students mid-year using attendance data before they drop out - not after. Directly protects ESFA funding tied to completion rates.

04

Data Quality

Try to have more fields as mandatory fields to improve Data Quality for better analysis.

Thank You

Questions Welcome

7,240

Records Analysed

49%

Enrolment Rate

8

Quality Issues Found

4

Recommendations